because there are too many minorities and no tolerance. We believe that Sunni Musalmaan should be on top, with the result those poor people are stuck with such beliefs' (Focus Group, Private University[5]). While minority sects across the country fell victim to sectarianism, Karachi became a particular battleground, given its '*too diverse a culture*'. During the 1980s, under Zia's Islamization being a Muslim was no longer enough, one had to be a Sunni Muslim. Between 15 and 20 per cent of Pakistanis were at risk of attacks from the majority. This was nothing new as the anti Ahmadi movement had already led to sectarian violence. This time however a much larger community was in effect made 'fair game' for those who espoused purist Sunni views. One cannot lay all the blame at Zia's feet. Geopolitics played its role in increasing sectarian violence as well. The Iranian Revolution of 1979 influenced Shia Islam in Pakistan and returning Gulf workers found that one way of countering a rise in Shia madrassas was to build Sunni madrassas. This movement of madrassa building was actively supported by Saudi Arabia, keen to export its Wahhabi form of Islam. Over the next few decades the various sects, including the Deobandi, Barelvi and Ahle Hadith factions of Sunnism, built competing seminaries. Another element of geopolitics that supported increased anti-minority violence and supported the rise of an extremist interpretation of Sunni Islam was the creation of the mujahideen to fight off the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan. The radicalization was initially outward facing (and supported by the United States, including the University of Nebraska Omaha that printed related books to radicalize the youth); however, a parallel radicalization of Pakistan's education system occurred internally as discussed in Chapter 3 on education.

While sectarian violence was the major cause of violent death, and sectarian divisions were the major cause for terror in the 1980s and 1990s, 9/11 and the subsequent war in Afghanistan fuelled a new form of terror with the rise of the Taliban in Afghanistan and later the creation of the Pakistani Taliban whose main aim was to fight the Pakistani state. The face of terror changed post 2002 as different radical groups, many of which had bases across the border in Afghanistan or in the tribal areas of northern Pakistan, started a campaign against first military and then increasingly civilian targets.

For young Pakistanis in this study, the reasons for such violence ranged from Pakistan's involvement in the Soviet war to international conspiracies to destabilize Pakistan.[6] '*Well the origin of it can go back to the Soviet-US problem when the mujahideen were fighting against the Soviets. However today they are on a vengeance of some misguided sort against the state as a whole. On top of that you*